

tion

1. The Elevate coach will model coaching during a coaching demonstration. The group will observe the discussion and identify what they're noticing the coach does well, and where they could do something differently

1. In pairs, participants will move into breakouts and practice coaching based on one of the scenarios

Certification

Elevate+ Certification is a time to demonstrate everything you've learned and celebrate your new skills and self awareness as you continue to grow as a leader of leaders at GitLab. It's not meant to be scary, and we want all participants to feel fully supported to pass.

Certification will occur in a live, collaborative, 60 minute session with up to 4 other Elevate+ participants, likely in your cohort, and will follow this format:

1. Intro to certification logistics

1. Part 1: Leadership presentations - 5 min presentation/1 min scoring per person x 4 people

1. Part 2: Coaching scenarios - 5 min per person x 4 people

Review these materials to best prepare for certification:

1. Scoring Rubric: Elevate+ coaches will use this rubric to assess your performance during the certification.

1. Coaching Scenarios: During Part 2 (as explained below), participants will practice their coaching skills using one of these scenarios.

Part 1: Leadership Presentation with Peer Evaluation

Each person will have 5 min (maximum) to give a brief presentation about their leadership and collect peer scores. The presentation should include answers to the following questions:

1. What are 2-3 learnings from the program that made a difference in your development, the way you lead, or your partnership with cross-functional stakeholders?

1. What personal focus areas became clear to you during the program?

1. What are your goals for developing your organization? Please share at least one goal for each category:

- Developing and coaching team members
- Developing and communicating your organizational strategy
- Building or improving cross-functional partnerships

Each participant will be assessed by their peers using the rubric above and the following scale:

- 1= Does not demonstrate or missing: Does not meet the criteria outlined for this element
- 2= Average: Demonstrated the objective partly or incompletely
- 3= Met Criteria: Met all objective requirements

Part 2: Deep dive into coaching

Each person will use scenarios to demonstrate mastery of coaching skills learned throughout the program.

Review the scoring rubric to understand which coaching skills will be assessed.

Making up missed sessions

Attendance to all Elevate+ live sessions is required to earn the certification. We understand that making time for all live sessions can be difficult. We have options for making up sessions you've missed:

Option 1: Attend Another Session

There are multiple Live Learning and Cohort Workshop options for each module. If you cannot attend your scheduled sessions, Option 1 is to attend another scheduled session.

Option 2: Async Makeup

If none of the Live Learning sessions will work, you may use Option 2: Async Makeup. Note that this can only be used a total of one time per participant.

Async makeups will be shared with participants directly via Level Up. They include watching recordings from the Live Learning and responding to text-based discussion threads in Level Up.

There is no async makeup option for Cohort Workshops.

Measuring Success

We're using the Elevate+ 360, delivered via Culture Amp, to both measure success of the program and give participants personalized feedback on their leadership styles.

Self-Assessment: Participants will complete a self-assessment, reflecting upon their current abilities and confidence as a leader of leaders. After the program, participants will re-take the assessment to demonstrate growth.

Stakeholder Assessment: Identified stakeholders will receive an (anonymous!) survey to gather feedback both for participants to identify areas they want to focus on during the next 6 months as well as overall program feedback. Stakeholders will be surveyed again 6 months after the program to measure collective leadership growth of the Elevate+ participants. This is a fantastic opportunity to collect and take action on feedback from those you work closely with.

Participants will nominate 2-3 stakeholders for the assessment. Their manager and direct reports will also be sent the assessment.

Who sees the assessment results?

1. The Elevate program team will look at cumulative results, vs individual results.
1. Stakeholder results will be shared with you directly for use in the program.

Results from the self and stakeholder assessments will be used throughout the program, during

workshop sessions and intersession work, to inform and personalize the material for each participant.

Frequently Asked Questions

What does success in Elevate+ look like?

To earn the final Elevate certification, participants must:

1. Attend or makeup all live sessions
1. Complete all async intersession work
1. Pass the Elevate+ Certification

Is my participation in Elevate+ required?

Yes, this and Elevate are both a required training for all people leaders at GitLab.

Where do I communicate my questions, concerns, and feedback as I go through the program?

When the program begins, you'll be added to a Slack group that includes all members of your cohort. You can also reach out directly to your manager or the Learning and Development team.

I missed, or cannot attend, a live session. What do I do?

It's a requirement to make up missed sessions within each month to ensure that you're learning each new skill and moving through the program in the appropriate order. Please make every effort to attend live sessions as scheduled. Please review makeup options outline above.

We're committed to working with you to find a solution that let's you successfully complete Elevate. If you must miss one live session for personal reasons, you need approval from your manager. Additional missed sessions will result in an incomplete Elevate status.

What if I have already completed the manager challenge?

The Manager Challenge is a past iteration of leadership development at GitLab. We appreciate the time that past manager challenge participations have dedicated to their growth and development. Elevate is the next iteration in our GitLab manager journey, and is still required of manager challenge participants.

When I complete this program will I earn a certificate?

Yes! Upon successful completion of the program, including attendance to all required live sessions, asynchronous learning, and assessments, participants will be awarded the GitLab Elevate+ certification.

How often will this program run?

Our goal is to enroll all eligible managers into Elevate+ during FY25.

Is there opportunity to participate in the program if I am an aspiring manager?

Due to our priority to certify people leaders, participation by aspiring managers is not currently an option. We've put together a Level Up course available to all GitLab Team Members, to share the self-paced training content for each Elevate (please note, there is not yet an async option for Elevate+). You can check it out here: [Elevate Learning Materials](#)

I was asked to fill out the Stakeholder Assessment - what does this mean?

The Elevate+ stakeholder assessment is delivered via Culture Amp and helps Elevate+ participants integrate real time feedback into their leadership growth.

Being nominated to take this assessment means that an Elevate+ participant greatly values your feedback and is interested to learn your perspective about their leadership style. Participants will view their self assessment results alongside feedback from stakeholders, then use this data to guide goals they set during Elevate+.

The stakeholder assessment is sent to participants direct reports, manager, and co-workers they have nominated. If you receive a stakeholder assessment, we ask that you please take ~15 minutes to complete.

Important things to note:

1. Participants will not see names associated with feedback shared in Culture Amp. Feedback will be categorized based on who shares it: Manager, Direct Reports, and Co-Workers.
1. You might be nominated by multiple Elevate+ participants to take the assessment. Please consider taking it for each person that's nominated you. You'll receive a separate Culture Amp message and assessment link for each assessment.
1. Participants of current Elevate+ rounds might have also been nominated to take the assessment for their colleagues. This is expected - thanks for taking time to assess your fellow Elevate+ members!
1. The People Analytics team will have access to the entire survey data set, including names, and will use this to pull aggregate themes from across all Elevate+ participants.
1. If you're nominated to give feedback to someone that you feel you can't give adequate feedback to, based on your level of collaboration with them, please simply ignore the message from Culture Amp and any reminders.

SECTION: people-group/learning-and-development/elevate-programs/elevateplus/elevateplus-round3.md

Leaders at GitLab enable our mission that everyone can contribute. We need to equip our people leaders with the skills to lead globally dispersed, all-remote teams to support our business growth at scale.

This page outlines the updated format of Elevate+, for participants starting mid-September in our pilot program.

Through interactive workshops, 1:1 coaching, self-paced learning, and small group connections, Elevate+ enables senior leaders at GitLab to better understand and practice behaviors anchored in GitLab's values and leadership competencies, develop new skills to support high priority

business needs, and help establish and strengthen cross-functional connections.

Elevate+ will create a shared leadership development experience across the organization so that every leader has a solid capability to lead in alignment with our GitLab values. This program will focus on the leadership behaviors required to build high performing teams that deliver results for customers.

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<div style="padding:56.25% 0 0 0;position:relative;"><iframe src="https://player.vimeo.com/video/936433544?h=4499172070&badge=0&autoplay=0&playerid=0&appid=58479"
frameborder="0" allow="autoplay; fullscreen; picture-in-picture; clipboard-write"
style="position:absolute;top:0;left:0;width:100%;height:100%;" title="Welcome to
Elevate+"></iframe></div><script src="https://player.vimeo.com/api/player.js"></script>
```

Learner Outcomes

In Elevate+, participants will:

- 1. Understand and practice behaviors and frameworks anchored in GitLab's values and leadership competencies
- 1. Apply new skills to support their highest priority business needs
- 1. Build cross-division relationships and learning through small group cohorts
- 1. Collaborate with stakeholders to integrate their learnings into their day-to-day work in order to tackle real challenges
- 1. Take action on feedback from their team, leader, and cross-functional stakeholders to map out your and your teams' future growth

What concepts are taught in Elevate+?

Elevate+ spans a wide array of topics that enable leaders to build high performing teams:

Time Commitment

Elevate+ runs for a total of 13 weeks. Across this timeline, participants will attend one Kickoff session, 2 live virtual workshops, cohort connections, and 1:1 coaching. The program also includes short self-paced activities in Level Up.

[Click here for an interactive version of the program outline.](#)

Program Element	Duration	Description	Date
----	----	-----	----
Virtual Kickoff	50 Minutes	Review program expectations, build cross-functional connections, and discuss leading at GitLab	Wednesday, 2024-10-02 at 3:30pm UTC
1:1 Coaching	5 Hours	60 minute intro session, then 4 hours of flexible 1:1 coaching, in 30 or 60 minute sessions	Dates to be set by participants
Workshop I	2 Hours	Facilitated live instruction, group discussion, breakout groups, solo activities, and an E-Group guest presenter	Thursday, 2024-10-24 from 3:30 to 5:30pm UTC

| Cohort Connection | 25 Minutes | Meet with other Elevate+ leaders to discuss the application of values-driven leadership | Dates TBD |

| Workshop II | 2 Hours | Facilitated live instruction, group discussion, breakout groups, solo activities, and an E-Group guest presenter | Thursday, 2024-11-21 from 3:30 to 5:30pm UTC |

| Self-Paced Activities | Varied | Bite-sized courses and reflection activities to expand Elevate+ concepts | Self-Paced |

Professional Coaching

Professional coaching is a key pillar of the Elevate+ program. 1:1 coaching hours are meant to personalize the Elevate+ experience, providing dedicated time for participants to work through their own specific application of leadership at GitLab, and to problem solve with an experienced, trusted, and GitLab-trained professional coach.

Participants should consider these important expectations for professional coaching during Elevate+:

1. You'll meet with your coach for a total of 5 hours across the duration of the program.
1. Participants are expected to share their CultureAmp 360 reports directly with their coach.
1. First Session: Schedule your first session in the coaching portal. Your first session will be 60 minutes, providing space to get to know your coach and set development goals. This first session should happen before Workshop I on 2024-10-24.
1. Subsequent sessions: Schedule subsequent sessions for 30 or 60 minute sessions, on dates of your choosing, directly with your coach.
1. We recommend spreading out coaching hours throughout the length of the program. You'll likely schedule some sessions after Workshop II. That is expected (and encouraged!) so you can work with your coach on concepts discussed during the workshop.
1. Sessions can be rescheduled via the coaching portal if done before a 24 hour window. Sessions cancelled within a 24 hour window cannot be rescheduled.
1. You will likely complete your Elevate+ certification reflection exercise before you've finished your 5 coaching hours.

Measuring Success

The Elevate+ 360, delivered via Culture Amp, measures success of the program and gives participants personalized feedback on their leadership style.

Self-Assessment: Participants reflect upon their current abilities and confidence as a leader. After the program, participants will re-take the assessment to demonstrate growth.

Stakeholder Assessment: Participant's manager, direct reports, and 2-3 additional nominated stakeholders will receive an (anonymous!) survey to gather feedback. Review feedback with your manager and professional coach, and use it to drive personal development goals. This is a fantastic opportunity to collect and take action on feedback from those you work closely with!

Who sees the assessment results?

1. The Elevate program team will look at cumulative results, not individual results.
1. Stakeholder results will be shared with you directly for use in the program.
1. Participants are responsible with sharing their results for discussion with their manager

and professional coach

Get Support

When the program begins, you'll be added to a Slack group that includes all members of your cohort. You can also reach out directly to your manager or the Learning and Development team.

Upon successful completion of the program, including attendance to all required live sessions, professional coaching, and submission of a written reflection at the end of the program, participants will be awarded the GitLab Elevate+ certification.

Please note that Elevate+ is a required training for eligible people leaders at GitLab. Due to our priority to certify people leaders, participation by aspiring managers is not currently an option. We've put together a Level Up course available to all GitLab Team Members, to share the self-paced training content for each Elevate (please note, there is not yet an async option for Elevate+). You can check it out here: [Elevate Learning Materials](#)

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The stakeholder assessment is sent to participants direct reports, manager, and co-workers they have nominated. If you receive a stakeholder assessment, we ask that you please take ~15 minutes to complete.

Important things to note:

1. Participants will not see names associated with feedback shared in Culture Amp. Feedback will be categorized based on who shares it: Manager, Direct Reports, and Co-Workers.

1. You might be nominated by multiple Elevate+ participants to take the assessment. Please consider taking it for each person that's nominated you. You'll receive a separate Culture Amp message and assessment link for each assessment.

1. Participants of current Elevate+ rounds might have also been nominated to take the assessment for their colleagues. This is expected - thanks for taking time to assess your fellow Elevate+ members!

1. The People Analytics team will have access to the entire survey data set, including names, and will use this to pull aggregate themes from across all Elevate+ participants. The Talent Development team only has access to aggregate themes.

1. If you're nominated to give feedback to someone that you feel you can't give adequate feedback to, based on your level of collaboration with them, please simply ignore the message from Culture Amp and any reminders.

SECTION: people-group/learning-and-development/elevate-programs/elevateplus/participant-hub.md

Welcome to Elevate+

This handbook page will serve as your Elevate+ homebase. Here, you'll find important links, session descriptions, and resources for each module.

Quick Links

Navigate to frequently used links for Elevate+ below:

```
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  <div>
    <a href="https://gitlab.com/gitlab-people-elevate/elevate-plus-round-1/-/boards"
class="btn btn-primary" style="width:200px;margin:5px;">Interession Work - Cohorts 1, 2, and
3</a>
    <a href="https://gitlab.com/gitlab-people-elevate/elevate-plus-round-2/-/boards"
class="btn btn-primary" style="width:200px;margin:5px;">Interession Work - Cohorts 4, 5, and
6</a>
    <a href="https://handbook.gitlab.com/handbook/people-group/learning-and-
development/elevate-programs/elevateplus/" class="btn btn-primary"
style="width:200px;margin:5px;">Elevate+ Overview Handbook Page</a>
  </div>
</div>
```

Need Help?

Get help in your cohort Slack channel. Find links to each channel below:

```
<div class="flex-row" markdown="0">
  <div>
    <a href="https://app.slack.com/client/E03N1RJJX7C/C06D40B5CVD" class="btn btn-primary"
style="width:200px;margin:5px;">Cohort 1</a>
    <a href="https://app.slack.com/client/E03N1RJJX7C/C06D40CKNH5" class="btn btn-primary"
style="width:200px;margin:5px;">Cohort 2</a>
    <a href="https://app.slack.com/client/E03N1RJJX7C/C06DM0G418C" class="btn btn-primary"
style="width:200px;margin:5px;">Cohort 3</a>
    <a href="https://app.slack.com/client/E03N1RJJX7C/C06M2TPTWUX" class="btn btn-primary"
style="width:200px;margin:5px;">Cohort 4</a>
    <a href="https://app.slack.com/client/E03N1RJJX7C/C06MHBQ2XSP" class="btn btn-primary"
style="width:200px;margin:5px;">Cohort 5</a>
    <a href="https://app.slack.com/client/E03N1RJJX7C/C06MHBR0NH1" class="btn btn-primary"
style="width:200px;margin:5px;">Cohort 6</a>
  </div>
</div>
```

Live Session Best Practices

The goal of this program is to create a shared leadership development experience for all GitLab

leaders, and to ensure that each participant has the skills and capabilities they need to be an exceptional leader at GitLab. Elevate+ objectives are rooted in GitLab values, leadership competencies, and mission.

Making the most out of Elevate+:

- ·Keep your camera on
- ·...While we understand that multitasking is a way of working at GitLab, we notice that those who are fully - present contribute the most, and get the most from this program
- ·Be brave, ask questions, and share your perspectives
- ·Use this session guide and our synchronous GitLab shared space to learn from each other
- ·Stay curious and open to learning
- ·Have fun!

Certification

Elevate+ concludes with an oral certification to demonstrate your mastery of leadership competencies. Please review this handbook page for a detailed outline of the certification process.

Module 1: My Leadership Identity

My Leadership Identity is the starting point for Elevate+. Live sessions and intersession work will focus on building your self awareness, executive presence, and intentionality behind your behavior and impact on your team's results.

During Module 1, you will:

1. Understand and explain who you are as a leader and the impact you have on others
1. Understand the difference between leading a team and leading leaders
1. Discuss the GitLab values and how we can lead to bring our values to life as leaders
1. Consider what it takes to be a leader others want to follow
1. Explore unconscious bias · mine and how to manage my org's
1. Review what's next in the Elevate+ path

Key Links

1. Module 1 Feedback Form

Module 2: Leading to Empower

During Module 2, you will:

1. Explore why it is so important to develop your team members
1. Reflect on how position power shows up in your relationships and leadership
1. Align on why coaching is so important, what a foundational coaching model looks like, and key coaching frameworks to utilize
1. Learn best practices for creating a Culture of Feedback
1. Revisit the resources at GitLab for support with managing underperformance

Resources

<details>

<summary>Position Power</summary>

- Short LinkedIn Article: Positional vs. Position Power

</details>

Key Links

1. Module 2 Feedback Form

Module 3

In Module 3, create a shared understanding around the importance for your team members to understand how they each contribute to driving results for customers by:

1. Learn from each other about GitLab's core product, revenue streams, and customers
1. Understand why this knowledge is critical for leading to empower and leading for results
1. Provide tools, language, and resources for you to lead a conversation with your team members

Key Links

1. Module 3 Feedback Form

Module 4

In Module 4, increase your cross-functional effectiveness in order to clear the way for your team to get results.

1. Share your team's highest order purpose and alignment to GitLab's overall goals
1. Map your cross-functional partners within and outside GitLab
1. Learn skills for building and repairing relationships with key partners

Key Links

1. Module 4 Feedback Form

Module 5

More information to be added soon.

Key Links

1. Module 5 Feedback Form

SECTION: people-group/learning-and-development/growth-and-development/_index.md

The Growth and Development (G&D) Fund can be used by GitLab team members to receive reimbursement for approved growth experiences and opportunities at GitLab. Team members can be reimbursed for up to \$10,000 per calendar year for approved growth experiences, provided they meet all eligibility requirements.

Whether you want to upskill with new certifications, attend industry conferences, or explore courses to enhance your expertise, this fund is an amazing resource to help you shape your career at GitLab and support High Performing Teams.

The Growth and Development (G&D) fund is managed by the Talent Development team. For any questions, please contact a team member directly, or reach out in the [learninganddevelopment](#) slack channel.

If you've never used the Growth & Development Fund before, check out the short instructional course in Level Up to get a bitesize overview.

Eligibility

To use the Growth and Development fund, applicants must be full-time GitLab employees who meet performance expectations in their role and are not on 'leave' status.

Process

Here is a step by step guide on how to apply for G&D applications.

If it's your first time using the Fund, we've created a comprehensive guide on Level Up that walks you through the G&D process, complete with video tutorials and step-by-step examples. Check out the Growth & Development Explainer course.

Step 1 - Growth Conversation

Start by having a growth conversation with your manager to discuss the learning opportunity. It's important to talk through the timing, workload, and application timeline of the program to ensure coverage for your team. This conversation should allow time for you to apply for the program before it begins and allow your manager to ensure team capacity.

G&D Select is a directory of opportunities of recommended opportunities from GitLab team members.

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<summary>Manager Guidance: Growth Conversations & Recommending Opportunities </summary>

- All Growth and Development applications need manager approval, so applications from team members should not come as a surprise to you when they are created, but should come about as a result of ongoing Career Development conversations with your team. If you don't already have regular career development conversations planned in with your team members, we recommend scheduling these in so that you can better understand your team members' career goals.

- Take a look at the Support your team with Career Conversations course in Level Up for best practice on how to handle these conversations effectively.

- As a result of these career conversations, you may identify an opportunity that could be suitable for a Growth and Development Fund application that aligns with the team member's career goals. As a manager, you should try to look out for such opportunities to encourage this usage, it can make team members feel that they are valued and that you show an understanding and appreciation of their career goals, and want to play an active role in helping them achieve them.

- Individual OKRs and business goals should not be tied to GD opportunities, unless the individual team member thinks it's appropriate.

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Step 2 - Open an Issue

Create a new Growth & Development issue using one of the issue templates below. Please create your issue 30 days in advance of the beginning of your experience.

|G&D Issue Template|

|-----|

|Academic Study|

|Conference|

|Other G&D Types|

|Coaching Right Now (GitLab's coaching vendor of choice) Learn more about Coaching Right Now below.]

Step 3 - Gain Approval

Request approval on the issue. Depending on the cost of the application, different approval levels are required. In all instances, your direct manager should be the first approver in the issue.

Cost Tiers Approval:

- Manager Approval: \$0-\$1,000

- Manager + VP Approval: \$1,000.01 - \$5,000

- Manager + e-group Approval for any spend \$5,000.01 - \$10,000 (Apart from Sales & Marketing, where VPs can approve \$5,000.01 - \$10,000 spend)

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<summary>Manager Guidance: You should know what you are approving </summary>

- As a manager you are ultimately responsible for the performance and behaviours of your team members. Therefore, it's important that you understand the opportunities you are approving for your team members, and that you have discussed them during a career development conversation.

- You should feel in all instances that you are able to explain the reasoning and benefits behind your team members G&D fund applications.

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<summary>Manager Guidance: Approving Travel for Conferences and Workshops </summary>

- Our intent at GitLab is to pay for everything a team member needs when traveling to a conference, but there are a couple of things to be mindful of when approving these requests.
 - The G&D Fund should be used to pay for conference registration, tickets, etc.
 - The costs for traveling to and from a conference, including hotel stays and meals, comes from the Travel & Expenses budget of the requestor's department.
- These two costs should still be detailed in the Growth and Development request issue, they just need to be expensed separately.
- There may be budgetary concerns if a team member is applying for a conference that would incur significant travel and accommodation costs. When approving a team members' G&D request, managers should feel confident they have the approval of their budget owner. VP approval is required on all applications over \$1000 involving travel, so in most cases they will be made aware as a matter of course.
- If you have any questions, please reach out to the Learning & Development team for support.

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<summary>Guidance for Budget Owners </summary>

- If you are a budget owner for your department, you should know that any Travel Expenses incurred from Growth & Development related travel (usually for conferences), comes from your overall T&E budget. You may not be included on all G&D applications that impact your budget, so it's important that you communicate to managers in your team what they can or cannot approve when it comes to G&D travel, without your oversight.
- If you would like to be included in all G&D approvals where T&E budget is impacted, please communicate this to the managers in your team.

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Step 4 - Make Purchase & Complete your Opportunity

Once all necessary approvals have been given in your G&D application issue, you are OK to proceed with paying for your opportunity and any necessary travel arrangements.

All individual G&D requests should be paid for by the team member who has applied for the opportunity.

Once you have paid for the opportunity, you can proceed with taking part in, and completing it, in whatever form that might take.

Step 5 - Reimbursement

In most cases, the costs of Growth and Development requests are paid back to team members after

the opportunity has been completed. Team members should therefore be prepared to accept financial responsibility for the cost of the opportunity they have chosen. You can find further information about how reimbursement works for different types of G&D opportunities below.

However, all requests are eligible to have 50% of the costs repaid upfront, and 50% upon completion.

All expenses should be claimed via Navan using the following process:

1. Open a new expense claim in Navan using the Expense type G&D (Growth and Development).
1. Include a screenshot of your approved G&D issue, and add the link to your issue in the description.
1. Add a screenshot showing proof of completion for your application. (Read more about the eligibility for reimbursement for your application type below).

Travel Expenses

As is detailed in the issue template, details of travel-related expenses, including costs for travel, lodging, and meals, should still be included in your G&D issue for approval.

However, they must be expensed separately to your G&D claim, following GitLab's Travel and Expense policy. Add a link to your G&D issue in the claim description. Please select Growth and Development as the Classification for these expenses, but not as the 'Expense Type'.

50% Upfront Reimbursement

As an option, all requests can take advantage of a split disbursement option designed to help team members carry the financial lift of costly experiences. This split disbursement option allows for 50% of the costs to be reimbursed immediately after payment and the remaining 50% is reimbursed upon completion.

Here's how this workflow works:

1. After all necessary approvals, the requesting team member pays for the approved G&D experience.
1. The team member can submit the proof of payment in a Navan expense request, and the approved GitLab issue, to receive a reimbursement of 50% of the total costs. When submitting in Navan, please state explicitly in the Description section of your expense claim that this is for a 50% reimbursement, with a link to your approved G&D issue.
1. Upon completion, the team member will submit the proof of completion (certificate, completion email, etc.) along with that same approved issue to receive the remaining 50% of total costs.

Please note that upfront reimbursement does not extend to travel, hotel, or meals expenses as these are expensed from a separate budget, it can only be used for the cost of the Growth and Development opportunity, more details in the Workshops and Conferences section.

Step 6 - Close & Feedback

Once you have successfully claimed for reimbursement, please go back and close your issue. If

you found the G&D experience to be of significant benefit, and you would recommend it to other team members, please leave a comment in the G&D feedback issue, so that the Talent Development team can add the opportunity to our G&D Select page.

Types of Growth and Development Reimbursements

Please note the reimbursement section above before proceeding. The training budget does not include the cost for traveling to and from an event.

Conferences and Live Workshops

Please use the Academic Study issue template to open requests of this type.

Description: The costs of conference registration fees are eligible for G&D reimbursement. The costs for travelling to and from an event, as well as lodging and meals, should be expensed separately from the training budget following the existing travel expense policy, with your manager's approval. Please review current GitLab travel policy for the latest information on booking and planning conference travel.

We encourage people to be speakers in conferences. More information for people interested in speaking can be found on our GitLab Speaker Resources.

Reimbursement Requirements:

Reimbursement should be applied for after the conference, with proof of attendance submitted as part of the Navan claim.

For any meals, lodging, or travel - these should not be categorised using the G&D (Growth and Development) expense type and should be claimed in line with the Global Travel and Expense Policy. However, when submitting your T&E expenses, please add a link to your G&D issue in the description.

Courses

Academic Study

Please use the Academic Study issue template to open requests of this type.

Description: For academic courses relevant to your GitLab career development goals, the G&D Fund can be used to cover tuition and enrollment. Additional fees related to books, travel, supplies, etc, are not covered.

The course must be from a credentialed college or university and must be relevant to your career development goals and development. The relevance of the classes taken for each semester will be subject to the approval of the manager. The grade must be equivalent to a "B".

Reimbursement Requirements: A final grade report or transcript is required to receive reimbursement. If you are paying per module, you can submit for reimbursement after completing each module, providing evidence of completion in your Navan claim.

Professional Development/Certifications/Courses

Please use the Other G&D Types issue template to open requests of this type.

Description: Any certifications/licenses that you and your manager think will be relevant to your development. These may include shorter non-academic courses focusing on a specific job-related skill.

Eligibility for Reimbursement: A final grade report or satisfactory certificate of completion will be required to receive reimbursement.

Self-Service Learning Subscriptions

Please use the Other G&D Types issue template to open requests of this type.

Description: Providers like Coursera, LinkedIn Learning, Reforge, Masterclass, etc. Subscription costs can be reimbursed on a monthly basis. Applications for a subscription to these providers should include reference to specific courses the requester would like to take.

Reimbursement Requirements: Reimbursement can be claimed after the intended course has been completed and evidenced in your claim. If you would like to retain the license to complete other courses reimbursement can be claimed in line with the payment terms (e.g. on a monthly basis).

Language Courses

Please use the Other G&D Types issue template to open requests of this type.

Description: We want to support our team members where English may not be their first language. Managers are encouraged to recommend this to team members whose performance may be improved by further developing their English language skills. Business English for Non-Native Speakers course and the Improve your English Communication Skills Specialization are two good examples.

Other languages may be considered if their relevance to job performance is made clear. (E.g. you can't expense Spanish classes if you don't need to speak Spanish as part of your day to day work.)

Reimbursement Requirements: Reimbursement should happen upon course completion.

Code Based Learning

Please use the Other G&D Types issue template to open requests of this type.

Description: GitLab will pay for courses related to learning how to code (for example Learning Rails on Codecademy), regardless of your department. If you are new to development, we encourage you to learn Git through GitLab, and feel free to ask any questions in the git-help Slack channel.

Reimbursement Requirements: A final grade report or satisfactory certificate of completion are required to receive reimbursements.

Programming Books

Please use the Other G&D Types issue template to open requests of this type.

Description: Books related to programming, software development, and technical skills that support your career development at GitLab can be reimbursed through the G&D Fund. This is separate from GitLab's general book reimbursement benefit and requires manager approval as part of the G&D process. Books should align with your growth goals and development plan discussed with your manager.

Reimbursement Requirements: Submit proof of purchase (receipt) through Navan using the Expense type G&D (Growth and Development). Include a link to your approved G&D issue in the expense description.

Coaching

Please note, using G&D for coaching is only available for managers and leaders grade 8+. Team members job grade 4-7 can receive external coaching from Modern Health.

Coaching Right Now

Description: Professional coaching is available for managers and leaders job grade 8+ to support development in their professional area of interest. Team members job grade 4-7 can receive external coaching from Modern Health and internal coaching from our internal resources. Team members are expected to know their confidentiality obligations and are responsible for keeping coaching conversations SAFE.

Our partnership with Coaching Right Now connects team members with GitLab-vetted coaches - read their coaching bios [here](#). Team members can book 4, 6, or 8hrs of coaching. Availability is first come, first served. Pairing with a coach via Coaching Right Now saves time and energy looking for a coach that is aligned to GitLab values and way of working.

> Hear what GitLab team members are saying about Coaching Right Now:

- My coach was thoughtful and insightful. He took the time to learn about me, my wants and desires. He was able to provide actionable feedback and made the last 4 months of GitLab much better.
- I can tangibly see how this (coaching) investment has made me at least 20% more effective in my role, delighted in my role, and a more human leader.
- This was a great (coaching) program and I'm really happy I got to be a part of it. I have two of my managers who have signed up to work with coaches now as well.

The specifics of your coaching session will not be communicated to GitLab.

Coaching Right Now will invoice GitLab directly for the costs, you do not need to pay, or apply for reimbursement for these engagements.

Apply for a coach via Coaching Right Now by opening an issue using the coaching template.

Reimbursement Requirements: Remember only managers or Individual Contributors job grade 8+ are

eligible. Coaching Right Now will invoice GitLab directly for your engagement.

Other Coaching Opportunities

Coaching Right Now is our preferred and vetted coaching partner. If the coaches offered via Coaching Right Now do not fit your needs, please open an issue using the Other G&D Types template.

Reimbursement Requirements: After approvals, team members will provide a paid invoice to GitLab as proof for reimbursement at the end of their coaching engagement.

Professional Dues/Membership

Please use the Other G&D Types issue template to open requests of this type.

Description: Any professional development membership or dues that will be relevant to your growth and development.

Reimbursement Requirements: Professional membership to an accredited organization that aligns with your role. Professional dues needed in order to continue members in an accredited organization. An invoice for the dues/membership is required. Since there's no specific date of completion for this type of opportunity, it can be reimbursed after it has been purchased.

Wellbeing

For resources related to Wellbeing and Mental Wellness, please take a look at GitLab's Employee Assistance Program, Modern Health. The Growth and Development Fund should not be used for things like therapy, counseling, mindfulness apps, etc.

Please use the Your 4th Trimester issue template to open requests of this type.

Your 4th Trimester Coaching

Please use the Other G&D Types issue template to open requests of this type and tag @jallen16 into your issue for processing.

Description: Your 4th Trimester is a 90-day coaching program with Broad Perspective Consulting. The purpose of the program is to help parents (regardless of gender) be as prepared as possible to be a working parent through coaching and development. The cost of this program is \$2,300 USD.

For Your 4th Trimester applications, please open up an issue using the Other G&D types template, then assign to @jallen16 and to your manager for approval. VP approval isn't required for this engagement. Once approval is confirmed you'll be put in touch with our Y4T coach via email.

Reimbursement Requirements: Team members leaving for or returning from Parental Leave. The provider will invoice GitLab directly.

Bulk Applications

If you're submitting a bulk application, where multiple team members are applying for the same opportunity, at the same time, please consider the following:

- If multiple team members are doing the same training or attending the same conference, please open one issue.
- Each team member should pay for their own expenses and process their own reimbursement through Navan. Team Members or Managers should not cover the expenses of other team members, as any reimbursements will count against their Growth and Development allowance.
- All bulk applications should still follow the reimbursement workflow via Navan where expenses can be claimed after completing the course or attending the conference. They should not be paid for by any other methods.

Company-directed Learning Opportunities

The Growth and Development policy is meant to further team members' learning and growth. Company-directed learning opportunities, such as mandatory conferences or training required to fulfill job duties, aren't within the scope for G&D and should be budgeted for outside the policy.

I'm a manager who would like to use the G&D Fund for a training for my whole team, is that allowed?

The G&D Fund is primarily designed for individual use, and each team member is entitled to use the Fund for their own career development. However, if each individual in a team has G&D allowance remaining, there may be instances where a team-based or manager led opportunity is suitable. Please reach out in the learninganddevelopment channel to discuss the suitability of the opportunity you are recommending. The team will review these on a case by case basis.

Policy Notes / FAQs

Overspending

If you are found to have reimbursed over \$10,000 within a calendar year, you will be required to pay back anything over \$10,000 that has been spent.

Recoupment of Growth and Development Reimbursements

If you voluntarily terminate employment with GitLab prior to completing twelve consecutive months of active employment, academic study or tuition expenses of \$1,000 USD and over will need to be refunded to GitLab.

How can I track my G&D spend?

If you wish to know how much of your G&D Fund you have remaining for the calendar year, please reach out in the learninganddevelopment slack channel.

We are working on improving this process and hope to provide a self-service option soon.

Does budget rollover?

Unspent G&D budgets do not 'rollover' from one year to the next, the maximum any team member can expense per year is \$10,000.

Can spare budget be shared with team members?

Budgets are individual and cannot be shared across teams. E.g. If one team member has \$5000 remaining, this can't be attributed to another team member to pay on their behalf.

Can I pay for one opportunity over multiple years?

If your G&D opportunity is across more than 1 year, you can distribute the costs by reimbursing across multiple years. However, you still cannot exceed \$10,000 expensed per year,

Tax Implications

In some countries, the Growth and Development Fund may be considered as taxable income and can be (partially) exempted from personal income taxes or subject to employer withholding taxes. Check the tax table for any tax implications in your country.

For example, in the United States 2021 tax year, if GitLab pays over \$5,250 for educational benefits for you during the year, you must generally pay tax on the amount over \$5,250. GitLab should include in your wages (Form W-2, box 1) the amount over \$5,250 in income.

Please contact Payroll for any tax-related questions in your country.

SECTION: people-group/learning-and-development/growth-and-development/processing-g-and-d.md

Processing documentation for the Talent Development team

Administration of Growth and Development Fund applications is the responsibility of the Talent Development Team. This handbook page will go over the admin notes of what's required when processing applications.

Processing Growth and Development Applications

All applications can now be reimbursed via Navan. Therefore, in general, the Talent Development team do not need to take action in the processing of G&D reimbursement requests, but are available to offer support and answer questions.

The Talent Development team are working on a new reporting process to track team member spendings stays in line with the \$10,000 budget limit.

Administration of Your 4th Trimester

1. If the team member lives in a country where this benefit is considered taxable income (currently only in Australia and some cases in Belgium), notify payroll.

1. Total Rewards will send an introductory email to Your 4th Trimester to the team member and Barbara Palmer barbara@your4thtrimester.com outlining the expected leave date, expected return

to work date and date of birthing event. Barbara will conduct the intake with the team member and communicate directly for any coaching throughout the program.

Billing:

Your 4th Trimester will bill GitLab for this benefit quarterly with 50% at intake and 50% at the completion of the coaching program per participant. If there are more than 5 participants in a quarter, there will be a discount on the bill. If there are any tax implications for the GitLab team member, Total Rewards will work with payroll to ensure this is reported compliantly.

Recoupment of Growth & Development Reimbursements

Process for Total Rewards Analysts for recouping Growth & Development reimbursements of over \$1000 USD:

- Check when the reimbursement was processed (via payroll changes sheets)
- Ask payroll for the pay stubs
- Fill out a Recoupment Notice Form
- Have the form audited by someone in the Total Rewards team
- Stage the document in DocuSign
- Fill out the Growth & Development Recoupment Log

SECTION: people-group/learning-and-development/growth-and-development/tax.md

Introduction

The reimbursement of Growth & Development benefits may be considered as taxable income in some countries. Subject to changing local legislation, the table below outlines what the tax impact might be on receiving Growth & Development reimbursements from GitLab.

Tax Impact Table

Country	Category	Tax Impact
United States	Academic Study	If GitLab pays over \$5,250 for educational benefits for you during the year, you must generally pay tax on the amount over \$5,250
	Your 4th Trimester Coaching	TBD
	Professional Coaching	TBD
	English Language Courses	If GitLab pays over \$5,250 for educational benefits for you during the year, you must generally pay tax on the amount over \$5,250
	Professional Development/Certifications/Licenses	If GitLab pays over \$5,250 for educational benefits for you during the year, you must generally pay tax on the amount over \$5,250
	Professional Dues/Membership	TBD
	Workshops and Conferences	TBD
	Self-Service Learning (LinkedIn Learning, Coursera, Others)	TBD
South Africa	Academic Study	Generally, any bona fide scholarship or bursary granted to

enable or assist any person to study at a recognised educational or research institution is exempt from normal tax. This exemption is, however, subject to certain conditions, particularly where the scholarship or bursary is granted by an employer (or an associated institution in relation to that employer) to an employee or to a relative of such employee. |

| | Your 4th Trimester Coaching, Professional Coaching, English Language Courses, Workshops and Conferences, Self-service learning (LinkedIn Learning, Coursera, others) | Expenditure in connection with in-house or on-the-job training or courses presented by training institutions for or on behalf of employers does not represent a taxable benefit in the hands of the employees of the employer if the training is job-related and at the employer's premises. This is in terms of paragraph 10(2)(c), which provides that no value will be placed on the benefit derived by employees on services rendered by the employer to his or her or its employees at their place of work for the better performance of their duties. |

| | Professional development/ certification/ licenses, Professional dues/ membership | EXEMPT IF CRITERIA ARE MET Employer-paid professional fees, if such membership is a condition of employment |

| Australia | Academic study, Your 4th Trimester Coaching, Professional coaching, English language courses, Professional development/ certification/ licenses, Professional dues/ membership Workshops and Conferences, Self-service learning (LinkedIn Learning, Coursera, othera) | Broadly speaking if you are reimbursing an employee for any out-of-pocket expenses they have incurred, no taxation would apply. However, if the intent of the business is to give the employee an allowance to cover the costs of the below, then there would be scope for the payment to be taxable. The client's company accountant would be the one to make the determination based on the nature of the payment and once that determination has been reached we can treat it accordingly in the payroll Paypac: In that case this is definitely up to the determination of the company accountant/BAS Agent. As the creation and lodgement of FBT returns are outside of the scope of payroll, we are not able to make this determination on behalf of the client. A resource that they can consult for this is here:

[https://www.ato.gov.au/General/Fringe-benefits-tax-\(FBT\)/Types-of-fringe-benefits/](https://www.ato.gov.au/General/Fringe-benefits-tax-(FBT)/Types-of-fringe-benefits/). In reading through the page and the below, the items appear to closely look like the examples of expense payment fringe benefits but again, that is just my opinion and I would still rely on their accountant to make this decision. However, once that determination is made and if there are reportable FBT amounts that need to be reported for employees on the STP file, we can record these for the client. |

| Germany | Professional Development (Weiterbildung) | According to section 1.2 of this article professional development (Weiterbildung) paid by the employer is tax free. |

| Hungary | Academic study, Your 4th Trimester Coaching, Professional coaching, English language courses, Professional development/ certification/ licenses, Professional dues/ membership Workshops and Conferences, Self-service learning (LinkedIn Learning, Coursera, othera) | In principal training and education costs shall be recorded as expense of the company so ideally these are not staff costs. Only if there are no invoices issued in the name of the Company and we need to reimburse the cost to the employee. In this case this is taxable as regular salary, so e.g. if we reimburse net HUF 100.000 to the employee it means it is run through payroll as cca. gross HUF 150,000 and employer's contribution is 17% on top of this. |

| Mexico | Academic study, Your 4th Trimester Coaching, Professional coaching, English language courses, Professional development/ certification/ licenses, Professional dues/ membership Workshops and Conferences, Self-service learning (LinkedIn Learning, Coursera, othera) | In MX, all these expenses can be non-taxable, as long as the employee provides an invoice addressed to the employer's local legal entity. (the invoice needs to have the employer's tax number "RFC") So if the employee can provide an invoice addressed to Remote's legal entity in Mexico, it can be processed as non-taxable. Please note that it will required to be an invoice and not

a receipt since those are not valid for tax purposes. |

| Austria | Academic study, Your 4th Trimester Coaching, Professional coaching, English language courses, Professional development/ certification/ licenses, Professional dues/ membership Workshops and Conferences, Self-service learning (LinkedIn Learning, Coursera, othera) | Costs are deductible for the employer if the training is in regard to the employee's current profession or to a similar work. It is important that the training is based on an entrepreneurial/professional requirement. If the training is based on private cause then this is subject to tax if employer grants reimbursement. The tax may differ dependent on each case - we need the employee's info to give more details. |

| Netherlands | Academic study, Your 4th Trimester Coaching, Professional coaching, English language courses, Professional development/ certification/ licenses, Professional dues/ membership Workshops and Conferences, Self-service learning (LinkedIn Learning, Coursera, othera) | it's allowed and tax free to pay for conferences and college fees for employees in the Netherlands as long as they need this for their job. When we can document that the employee needs this to be able to do their work properly than it's fine to pay for this from the company and its tax free. The employee cannot deduct the costs for these in their income tax return because the company paid for it. |

| United Kingdom | Academic study, Your 4th Trimester Coaching, Professional coaching, English language courses, Professional development/ certification/ licenses, Professional dues/ membership Workshops and Conferences, Self-service learning (LinkedIn Learning, Coursera, othera) | Tax-free with the exception of Trimester coaching which doesn't sound business related. |

| Switzerland | Academic study, Your 4th Trimester Coaching, Professional coaching, English language courses, Professional development/ certification/ licenses, Professional dues/ membership Workshops and Conferences, Self-service learning (LinkedIn Learning, Coursera, othera) | A Swiss worker every year can submit valid expenses to the Swiss administration and might have a rebate on some amount. Taxation rules are different from one Canton to another. As these questions are related to tax a tax adviser would be better to answer these questions. |

| Italy | Academic study, Your 4th Trimester Coaching, Professional coaching, English language courses, Professional development/ certification/ licenses, Professional dues/ membership Workshops and Conferences, Self-service learning (LinkedIn Learning, Coursera, othera) | Unfortunately the below list refers to taxable expenses. Since the taxable expenses and allowance has the same rate of taxation, we would suggest to include a monthly (or eventual) Wellness Allowance (gross) which will be paid to the employee and recorded in the addendum. In this way the employees will avoid the expenses submitting process as well as GitLab will avoid to approve them. |

| Brazil | Academic study, Your 4th Trimester Coaching, Professional coaching, English language courses, Professional development/ certification/ licenses, Professional dues/ membership Workshops and Conferences, Self-service learning (LinkedIn Learning, Coursera, othera) | Any of the items below can not be taxable if it is just sent as expense reimbursement. If the requirement is to advance an amount for reimbursement, it would be required to invoice the amount first, and when the employee requires to buy any item, the ICE will make the deposit so the employee can buy and in the moment sends the vouchers to the ICE. |

| Japan | Academic study, Your 4th Trimester Coaching, Professional coaching, English language courses, Professional development/ certification/ licenses, Professional dues/ membership Workshops and Conferences, Self-service learning (LinkedIn Learning, Coursera, othera) | Payment that considering learning / Education, will be Non-Taxable & There will be no impact on Social Insurance & Labor insurance as well. |

SECTION: people-group/learning-and-development/learning-initiatives/_index.md

Learning Initiatives Introduction

The Learning & Development team is rolling out learning programs to enable a culture of curiosity and continual learning. The learning initiatives are intended to provide a forum for team members to come together to learn about all of the activities taking place in the learning space, as well as hear from leaders internally and externally on various leadership topics.

This page is currently under construction as we update with plans for FY26.

SECTION: people-group/learning-and-development/learning-initiatives/past-initiatives.md

Past Initiatives

Please note all information on this page is for reference and preservation only. None of these programs are currently running.

Monthly Continuous Learning Call Overview

The Learning and Development (L&D) team previously hosted a monthly Monthly Continuous Learning call. The series was intended to showcase all of the L&D initiatives taking place at GitLab as well as provide a space for team members to ask questions. The series was replaced in FY22 with involvement in company-wide Group Conversations in an effort to increase participation and attendance in the calls.

Goals

1. Spur a culture of curiosity and continuous learning by highlighting all the initiatives we have taking place in learning & development.
1. Increase engagement and improve team member satisfaction and productivity by advancing understanding of available L&D resources

Additional background information on this initiative is available in the Monthly Continuous Learning Call issue

Past Monthly Continuous Learning Call

Check out recordings of previous Learning Speaker Series calls!

- 2020-10-21 Monthly Continuous Learning Call
- 2020-11-18 Monthly Continuous Learning Call
- 2020-12-16 Monthly Continuous Learning Call
- 2021-01-20 Monthly Continuous Learning Call

Hosting a Monthly Continuous Learning Call

The following process outlines steps for the L&D team to take each month when planning and implementing monthly calls.

Planning Issue Template: Open an Monthly Continuous Learning Call issue template in the L&D Project. Steps outlined below are also included in the issue template and are included here as reference.

1. Create a HelpLab request to coordinate a Zoom meeting on the company calendar. This meeting should be set up to live stream to the GitLab unfiltered YouTube channel. Consider hosting the call at least 2 times to best accommodate for multiple time zones.
1. Create slide deck for presentation. Make a copy of a previous month's presentation in the Continuous Learning Campaign Google Folder
1. Coordinate slide deck with appropriate enablement audiences (i.e DIB, Field Enablement, Professional Services, Marketing Enablement, etc)
1. Update slide deck for presentation with feedback from coordinated audiences
1. Open a feedback issue for questions and comments to be shared asynchronously.
1. Coordinate an announcement of the call in the company-fyi Slack channel from Sid or another executive/manager who will be featured that month. The post should be shared 1 business day before the call. This post should include a link to the slide deck and corresponding issue. See notes below for a template that can be shared.

Text for CEO share in company-fyi channel

Join the Learning and Development team on [DATE] for the Monthly Continuous Learning Call. This month's call is all about [TOPIC]. You can review the slide deck for the call [HERE], and post questions you might have in the call agenda doc [HERE]. Looking forward to seeing you there!

What to Expect

The video below gives an overview of what the Crucial Conversations training looks like.

{{< youtube "UX-ArZJJ1U" >}}

A detailed training outline is included below:

Total program length: 4 Weeks

Time commitment per week: 3 Hours/week: ~2 hours self-paced and 1 hour live practice session per week.

Week Number	Topic	Commitment
----	----	----
1	Get Unstuck, Master my Stories 1, and Master my Stories 2	3 hours
2	Start with Heart, State my Path	3 hours
3	Make it Safe, Learn to Look, and Seek Mutual Purpose	3 hours
4	Explore Other's Paths, Move to Action	3 hours

Upon completion of the self paced material you will earn an official Crucial Conversations certification from Crucial Learning.

Results

Completion breakdown of managers and ICs

Team Member Role	Certifications Earned
All Team Member Completions	61
Manager Completions	11
Individual Contributor Completions	50

Last updated 2022-04

Feedback

Percentage of participants who agree	Feedback Question
100%	This course increased my confidence in having crucial conversations with my manager
92%	This course increased my confidence in having crucial conversations with team members who are not my manager
97%	I would recommend this course to a colleague
94%	The live session scenarios were relevant to my work at GitLab
80%	I am interested in participating in post-training review sessions

Reviews

> Overall I loved the course and the material. It felt very relevant and relatable. I especially liked the prompts that were created for the breakout sessions because it felt like there was a lot of thought put into trying to make the scenarios relevant to how we work at GitLab.

>

> This course taught me a lot about myself and how to make improvements when having crucial conversations!

>

> Crucial Conversations course provides a simple-to-understand set of tools and techniques that will help me be more candid and assertive in both professional and personal conversations. The self-paced study combined with weekly live sessions was moderately demanding, it provided nice accountability that nudged me towards learning each week.

>

> This course is fantastic! Within the first week, I was already able to apply real skills to conversations I have every day. I've always considered difficult conversations to be an area where I could really benefit from improvement and now I believe if I continue to practice and improve these skills, I will see significant results both in and out of work.

>

> The Crucial Conversations course helped me understand how I can be a better individual in all aspects of my life. There are a bunch of skills covered in the course that I can use in both my personal life and professional life that will help me better communicate with those around me, and - crucially - be more effective at moving through tough conversations about important topics.

Crucial Conversations Alumni

After you've completed the Crucial Conversations course at GitLab, there are a few ways you can

continue to practice your skills:

1. Attend the Crucial Conversations Alumni sync session. This 25-minute call happens every other month starting in January 2022. Check the GitLab team member's calendar for the invitation

1. Star and check the crucial-conversations Slack channel for async discussion every other month, starting in February 2022

1. Fork or copy this GitLab project for practicing Crucial Conversations. Use the issue templates in the project to create your own issues, set due dates, and practice your skills after you complete the certification.